



SOFT SHIELD FERN
Polystichum setiferum
 F: Dryopteridaceae
 Native to damp European woodlands, soft shield fern has feather-shaped fronds, with leaflets turned at an angle, instead of lying flat.

1.2 m
4 ft



OAK FERN
Gymnocarpium dryopteris
 F: Cystopteridaceae
 Delicate bright green fronds, sprouting separately, distinguish this northern fern. It grows in shaded screes as well as in woodland.

40 cm
16 in



OSTRICH FERN
Matteuccia struthiopteris
 F: Onocleaceae
 Native to the northern hemisphere, this tall waterside fern has a symmetrical crown of sterile fronds in summer, followed by brown fertile fronds in the winter.

1.5 m
5 ft

30 cm
12 in



COMMON POLYPODY
Polypodium vulgare
 F: Polypodiaceae
 Instead of forming clumps, this fern sprouts separate fronds along its creeping rhizome. It is common on rocks, trees, and leaf litter in northern temperate regions.

MALE FERN
Dryopteris filix-mas
 F: Dryopteridaceae

One of the commonest woodland ferns in Europe, this species has a crown of concentric fronds shaped like the tail of a shuttlecock.

spore capsules
on underside
of fronds

1.2 m
4 ft



40 cm
16 in

BRITTLE BLADDER-FERN
Cystopteris fragilis
 F: Cystopteridaceae

Named for its swollen spore capsules borne on the underside of its fronds, this fern grows in temperate regions worldwide.

60 cm
23½ in



toothed, pale
green leaflets

winged
midrib

SENSITIVE FERN
Onoclea sensibilis
 F: Onocleaceae

The fronds of this wetland fern from N. America and E. Asia seem very sensitive to cold, dying soon after the first frosts.

15 cm
6 in



WALL RUE
Asplenium ruta-muraria
 F: Aspleniaceae
 Widespread across the northern hemisphere, this small tuft-forming fern grows on limestone rocks and on walls containing lime-rich mortar.

HART'S TONGUE FERN
Asplenium scolopendrium
 F: Aspleniaceae

With its glossy, strap-shaped fronds, this fern is often cultivated as an ornamental plant. It grows wild in Europe, W. Asia, and N. America.

60 cm
23½ in



20 cm
8 in

MAIDENHAIR SPLENWORD
Asplenium trichomanes
 F: Aspleniaceae

Occurring from the tropics to sub-Arctic regions, this small clump-forming fern grows in rocky places. Its fronds have paired elliptical leaflets.

COMMON STAGHORN FERN
Platycerium bifurcatum
 F: Polypodiaceae

Found in Indonesia and Australasia, this impressive epiphyte grows on tree-trunks. It has kidney-shaped sterile fronds and spreading fertile fronds shaped like antlers.

90 cm
35 in

